

Ministry of Water, Land and Resource Stewardship

UPDATE: High Streamflow Advisory – South Coast, Vancouver Island

Issued: 1:00PM September 29, 2025

The River Forecast Centre is **issuing** a **High Streamflow Advisory** for:

- Fraser Valley (North)

The River Forecast Centre is **maintaining** a **High Streamflow Advisory** for:

- South Coast including Sunshine Coast, Howe Sound, Sea-to-Sky, North Shore Mountains, Metro Vancouver
- Vancouver Island

Weather Synopsis:

Two strong storm events impacted Vancouver Island and the South Coast over the weekend. The first storm, arrived late Thursday and lasted through Saturday, measured the highest precipitation totals on western Vancouver Island with stations ranging from 50 to 145 mm. Precipitation stations on the South Coast ranged from 20 to 65 mm for the event. The second storm arrived Sunday and is still impacting areas of the Lower Mainland. Precipitation totals for this event range from 40 to 140 mm on west Vancouver Island and 10 to 90 mm for the South Coast. Another storm system is forecast to arrive on Vancouver Island Tuesday evening and will impact the region and the South Coast into Thursday. An additional 40 to 100 mm of precipitation is likely from the upcoming event.

River Conditions:

In general, most river responses on Vancouver Island and the South Coast were subdued for the two weekend storm events due to prolonged dry conditions, unsaturated soils and lower than normal river levels leading up to the events. The Southgate River above Elliot Creek (08GD010) has reached 929 m³/s as of 10:10 PST on Monday. It represents a 50-year return period, however the station only has three complete years of data to create a return period analysis, so it's likely an over-estimation. The only other stations to reach above a 2-year flows were the Elaho River near the Mouth (08GA071) which is currently at 803 m³/s at 10:45am PST, and the Homathko River at the Mouth (08GD004) which peaked at 1,330 m³/s at 8:45am PST. With the upcoming third storm system arriving this week, rivers could respond more rapidly due to higher antecedent flow conditions and more saturated soils. Vancouver Island rivers are likely to experience peak flows Wednesday through Thursday, whereas rivers on the South Coast will likely be slightly later on Thursday.

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The [River Forecast Centre](#) continues to monitor the conditions and will provide updates as conditions warrant.

For information on how to prepare for flood hazards, visit [PreparedBC](#).

BC River Forecast Centre

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A **High Streamflow Advisory** means that river levels are rising or expected to rise rapidly, but that no major flooding is expected. Fast-flowing bodies of water increase risk to life safety. Minor flooding in low-lying areas is possible.

A **Flood Watch** means that river levels are rising and will approach or may exceed bankfull. Flooding of areas adjacent to affected rivers may occur.

A **Flood Warning** means that river levels have exceeded bankfull or will exceed bankfull imminently, and that flooding of areas adjacent to the rivers affected will result.